was fine when it had just been letters, and she could slip back into the person she'd been forty-five years ago. But so much had changed. She wasn't that person anymore.

"I know it's not easy for you," Katya said. "But maybe it's hard for Rose, too."

Léa feared that the love she'd felt all these decades for Rose would no longer be there when they met again after all these years. As long as Rose stayed in her memories, she could hold on to the past—and not have to face the present or how they'd both changed. "I'm sorry. It's silly, we've come all this way . . ."

"You don't have to meet her if you don't feel ready," Eve said, squeezing her mother's hand. "If you want, Katya and I can go for you."

"You'd do that?"

"Yes, Maman, we will," Katya said.

"What will you tell her?"

"That you need more time." Eve put her hand on her mother's shoulder. "She'll understand."

Léa feared she'd never be ready. She just couldn't do it.

Katya stood. "She's been waiting all morning. You stay here, and we'll come back."

Léa watched her two grown daughters—Katya, taller and older, Eve marching with that determined stride of hers—cross the street and walk toward her sister.

* * *

Friday morning. Rose had been waiting four days. She checked her watch—nearly twelve. She'd promised herself that she would wait every morning for the whole week, but she couldn't bear to continue sitting in this café alone. If Léa was coming, she'd have been here by now.

How could she have imagined that Léa would want to see her again? She had her own life with two daughters, a bright and happy life—why would she want to reunite with Rose and relive those terrible war years? Rose glanced at the sketchbooks on the table—the covers still stained with the faded marks of her blood. Her leg ached from the cold. *Go home*.

If she left now, she could still catch the two-thirty train and arrive in her